

PUBLIC OFFICE MODEL · REVIEWED 2026-09-07

How the Office works

One human-directed path from research and design to implementation, verification, and deliberate publication.

The Office gives public questions and shared work a clear route from inquiry to a reviewed result. It joins research, design, implementation, verification, and public explanation without confusing advice with authority.

Steve is the hinge: Front prepares; Back implements; nothing is approved until he says so.

One Office, two responsibilities

The **Front Office** researches, organizes, drafts, and reviews. It prepares a decision packet with the ask, evidence, options, risks, constraints, and acceptance conditions.

The **Back Office** implements an explicitly approved outcome in the project that owns it. It checks the current state, makes a bounded change, verifies the result, and returns evidence.

The names describe responsibilities, not competing teams. A person or tool may help in either office, but each handoff keeps its authority and review boundary.

The shared working loop

1. **Receive** - identify the request, audience, desired result, and constraints.
2. **Prepare** - gather sources, distinguish facts from proposals, and make the decision clear.
3. **Approve** - Steve decides whether the packet may cross into implementation or publication.
4. **Implement** - make the smallest coherent change in the owning project.
5. **Verify** - test the result, inspect what people will see, and record remaining gaps.
6. **Publish or hand back** - release only approved public material and preserve a reviewable source.

What crosses the boundary

A packet going in carries the ask, constraints, stewardship vetoes, and acceptance conditions. A result coming back carries verification evidence and any remaining uncertainty. Every crossing is specific; no packet creates standing permission to publish, contact people, spend money, or change production.

Knowledge and publication

The public Office door is <https://office.signwriting.org/>. Reviewed public explanations may be published there when Steve authorizes them. Auto-generated method guides on www.sutton-signwriting.io are retired.

Private handbooks retain correspondence, account administration, local systems, recovery procedures, unpublished work, and other operational detail. Public and private editions may share language, but publication is always a deliberate reviewed copy. Private files are never mirrored automatically.

Human authority

Office roles and automated tools may research, organize, challenge, draft, implement, and verify within an approved task. A human remains responsible for decisions, external communication, publication, spending, account creation, commitments, and production changes.

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